Carrowmore

The problem
By 2029, 340 lighthouse keepers will need support finding alternative employment as their current roles disappear. The deployment team has information about keepers and available jobs, but cannot easily identify and recommend suitable candidates for interview. The primary user is the deployment team, which needs to identify keepers to recommend to recruiters asap.

The hypothesis
A platform bringing together existing keeper working experience and job information can help the deployment team quickly identify potential candidates by showing skills-matching scores and certification alignment for each keeper against each job. The team can review the supporting evidence and share recommendations with recruiters.

Risks

Risks	Level	Next steps (what to build and what not)
• Data accuracy: The skills and certification information accurately reflects each keeper's capabilities and qualifications.	Medium	The data issue cannot be resolved regardless what solution to use, so it's not one I will be validating.
• Matching validity: The scoring method meaningfully differentiates candidates according to job requirements and identifies credible potential matches.	Low	The matching mechanism could vary based on jobs, and this could be adjusted based on expertise, so it's not a fundamental risk to concern about now.
• Keeper willingness: Keepers will want and be able to pursue the recommended roles, including undertaking additional training where necessary.	High	This information is not available in the system and not something can be obtained easily, **so this is the highest risk area I would validate with a prototype**

The process
I used Claude to create prototype based on a series of prompts and a mixed of clean and raw data. I asked AI to match keepers to jobs using the cleaned data and job requirements, but I had to challenge its assumptions. It used job adverts rather than the skills framework, gave skills and certifications equal weight, and treated all certifications as equally difficult to obtain. It also scored skills based on logbook entries without considering how recent or frequent the experience was. I changed the matching logic to reflect these differences. The scores remain indicative and would need validation before real use.

The findings
I tested the prototype with one person playing the deployment team role. Initially, they thought the available information was sufficient for job matching. However, when examining an offshore technical role, they questioned whether a keeper would want to spend extended periods away from family, or undertake high-voltage training if they lacked the required certification. Seeing 34 years of service also prompted them to question the candidate's age and whether someone aged 66 would want to retrain.

This indicates the platform can identify potential skills and certification matches, but the available information does not establish if a keeper wants the role or is willing to complete additional training. If recommendations overlook these factors, the platform could produce technically suitable shortlists without creating real redeployment opportunities, that's a waste of interview.

Conclusions
With the findings, I think the strategy direction is wrong.

If this turns into a product, I will keep the mechanism of the matching of skills / certification and the usability. But overall I'd like to pivot towards a keeper's platform instead of a deployment team platform.